

White House News Collection (1968-2025)

Julia Christensen[†]

July 15, 2026

Abstract

This paper examines how presidents and their staffs have monitored, summarized, and circulated news inside the White House from the Nixon administration to the present. Drawing on a variety of primary sources and press accounts, I examine the evolution of White House media monitoring. Before 2001, each administration assigned an internal team to produce daily news summaries. These operations varied substantially. Beginning with George W. Bush, White House media monitoring was outsourced to Bulletin Intelligence. Subsequent administrations continued to hire the same company, which created greater continuity across administrations. Nevertheless, the content and format of the summaries continued to adapt to changing technologies, expanding media environments, and the needs of each administration.

By reconstructing this institutional history, I shed light on a critical aspect of governance. In the face of an overwhelming volume of information, Presidents and their staffs rely on information-filtering institutions like the White House news summary. These systems determine which events, perspectives, and signals reach the White House. This paper provides historical context necessary for studying these processes and for understanding how media information reaches the White House.

Word count: 11,642

1. Introduction

On February 5, 2010, the Obama administration and Democrats in Congress faced a pivotal decision. They were in the final phase of passing the Affordable Care Act (ACA) when a special election eliminated their filibuster-proof majority in the Senate. Suddenly, resistance among House Democrats to the Senate bill presented an existential threat to the ACA (Connolly, 2010). Politico described “a party that was on the brink of a political and nervous breakdown in late January” (Budoff Brown & Thrush, 2010). At this pivotal moment, the future of the ACA was uncertain. Yet the ACA would pass less than two months later. How did this reversal happen? According to press coverage at the time, credit can be partially traced back to the White House news summary and a Los Angeles Times article about a routine bureaucratic decision (Barabak & Helfand, 2010).

Months earlier, Anthem Blue Cross, California’s largest for-profit health insurer, submitted a plan to California state regulators. Anthem proposed a double-digit rate increase for insurance policies held by fewer than a million Americans. The plan, like so many others, went through a routine regulatory review and was approved with little pushback or press attention (Barabak & Helfand, 2010). Luckily for the Obama administration, this time the rate hike did make the news (Helfand, 2010). Although not a major national story, it was collected and distributed to White House staff as part of the White House’s daily news summary.

On February 5, Dan Pfeiffer, a senior White House strategist, spotted the article and realized its potential to change the public conversation about health insurance (Barabak & Helfand, 2010). Anthem “had given Obama, who struggled for months to find a cogent argument, a simple way to crystallize his case for change” (Barabak & Helfand, 2010). In the days following the story, Obama would go on the offensive, using his bully pulpit to criticize Anthem’s rate increase and paint it as “a portrait of the future if we don’t do something now” (Barabak & Helfand, 2010). Anthem’s rate increase became a centerpiece of the White House’s communications strategy and would be picked up by allies in Congress, who bolstered the president’s message by summoning Anthem executives to testify in committee hearings (Barabak & Helfand, 2010). While recognizing other factors, media coverage from the time credits Anthem’s rate hikes with changing the narrative and momentum around the ACA, which was critical to its eventual passage (Barabak & Helfand, 2010; Budoff Brown & Thrush, 2010).

The ACA episode illustrates how news media can shape governance by influencing what information reaches the White House. Presidents depend on media monitoring to collect, filter, and summarize information about developments inside and outside government. Because these processes operate largely out of public view, their influence is difficult to measure directly. Even so, presidents and their advisers have repeatedly described White House news summaries as important sources of information.

On occasion, presidents have directly identified news summaries as a source of important information. For example, in a press conference, Gerald Ford cited his morning news briefing when discussing foreign policy: “I noticed in the morning news summary before I left Washington that the President of the Philippines, Mr. Marcos, is reviewing the Philippine relationship with the United States” (Ford, 1977).

Ford’s case is not the only time that White House media monitoring factored into a

president’s response to unfolding events. In a tribute to George H.W. Bush, a staffer recalls interrupting a meeting between the president and British Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher with a breaking news story (Cooper, 2018). Mikhail Gorbachev had just issued an ultimatum demanding that Lithuania rescind its recent declaration of independence and restore Soviet law. The speed and force of Bush and Thatcher’s joint response was noted in contemporary press coverage: “The fact that the intensely cautious Mr. Bush, acting for himself and Mrs. Thatcher, chose to bring up the news report at the outset of the news conference, before they were asked about it, illuminated the alarm with which the two leaders viewed the Kremlin’s ultimatum more than their words did” (Cooper, 2018).

Records also show that presidents rely on news summaries to monitor events within the White House. One of the best accounts of White House media monitoring comes from an oral history of Jimmy Carter’s Press Secretary, Jody Powell. Powell recalled instances where Carter took immediate action directly after reading the news summary: “On occasion he [Carter] would comment on the stories that said the President is considering doing such-and-such, when he didn’t even know we were considering the problem at all yet—wondering who it was that was passing himself off as being the President and considering such a thing” (Powell, 1981).

Beyond specific incidents, the historical record speaks more generally to the importance of the White House news summary to presidents and their staff. In his tribute, George H.W. Bush’s staffer also recalls how the president valued the morning news summaries produced by his staff. The president “would frequently walk around with our Summaries, highlighted in parts with items to be addressed” (Cooper, 2018). Other accounts emphasize that the summaries served a much broader audience than the president alone. Carter’s Press Secretary describes the White House news summary as “a very important source of information for everybody around the White House” (Powell, 1981). They were a routine part of White House activities, helping presidents and their staffs monitor events, share information, and coordinate the work of governing.

These accounts provide a tantalizing glimpse into the potential importance of news. However, the ubiquity of White House media monitoring is perhaps the most powerful evidence of its importance. Since Richard Nixon, each subsequent administration has continued to invest in news collection, analysis, and distribution. Moreover, White House news collection efforts are not merely the product of bureaucratic inertia. They continuously evolve to meet the needs of each administration and adapt to changes in technology and the media ecosystem.

Why would presidents monitor the news? In their 1981 book, Michael Baruch Grossman and Martha Joynt Kumar describe a range of benefits: “The White House News Summary keeps the President informed about the coverage the media give to his administration, provides items for his agenda, gives the staff an additional means of legitimizing their activities, and allows readers of the summary to learn whether the President is aware of certain items” (Grossman & Kumar, 1981, p. 102). Subsequent scholarship suggests additional motives for White House media monitoring. Presidents can also use news to monitor their own communications efforts and to communicate with other parts of government (Cook, 1998). Additionally, presidents use the media for reality testing. As an outside source, news allows a president to form a sense of reality and test the information being provided by internal channels of information (Burke & Greenstein, 1989; Karpowitz, 2009). Lastly, news summaries

helped the White House monitor public opinion (Karpowitz, 2009).

More broadly, White House media monitoring helped construct the informational environment in which presidents governed. The design of these systems determined how information was filtered, organized, and prioritized. In an environment where time and attention are scarce and information abundant, media monitoring operations shaped which events, perspectives, and signals reached the White House. Even when information can be collected through other means, news media is often an efficient and cost-effective solution.¹ Rather than create expensive systems for comprehensive data collection, presidents and their staffs often rely on journalists, editors, and news organizations to identify and investigate events of potential importance.

This paper begins with Nixon because his administration marked the emergence of the modern White House news summary and the beginning of a relatively continuous institutional lineage.² Drawing on archival records, oral histories, contracts, press accounts, and other sources, I examine how successive administrations have collected, analyzed, and distributed news from 1968 through today. During this period, daily news reports were produced for the president and distributed widely among White House staff (Karpowitz, 2009; Kumar & Sullivan, 2003). According to Kumar & Sullivan (2003), the news summary is “a document describing and quoting from articles in newspapers and on television. It reflected the administration’s interest in how they were covered, including providing a sense of what the major news stories were on any given day” (p. 244). Among some staffers, this summary is known as the internal White House newspaper (Kumar & Jenkins, 1999).

While every administration since Nixon produced daily news reports, the systems used to collect, organize, and distribute information changed substantially over time. When computer technology transformed both news production and news collection, White House media monitoring evolved from an in-house model to a service provided by an outside contractor. Before 2001, administrations developed their own internal media-monitoring operations, which led to considerable variation in organizational structure and output. Starting in 2001, production was outsourced to a contractor. Each subsequent administration chose to hire the same company, Bulletin Intelligence, creating greater continuity. Nevertheless, despite similar procedures for news collection and summary production, news summaries continued to be shaped by internal and external forces, including changes in technology, the media environment, and presidential priorities.

¹See also McCubbins & Schwartz (1984). While McCubbins and Schwartz assume that individuals or interests groups pull the fire alarm, news coverage can also play this role. The efficiency of news as an information source can also be found in primary sources. When discussing the cost effectiveness of information gathering, one of George H.W. Bush’s intelligence aides explained that he pushed agencies to “ask is this information really worth the risk we’re taking to get it?” and argued that “We don’t need to go recruit an agent to tell us something we can read about in the newspaper” (Gates, n.d.).

²Before the expansion of the Executive Office of the President (EOP) in the 1940s and 1950s, presidents faced a different set of institutional constraints. For example, Franklin Delano Roosevelt had an expansive operation for monitoring news coverage and compiling clips into a daily “Press Intelligence Bulletin” (Stiles, 2017). However, due to resource limitations, the operation was housed in the Commerce department and was vulnerable to changes in congressional appropriations. In 1947, a Republican Congress “put it out of business” (Stiles, 2017, p. 250). Nixon broke from his immediate predecessors by investing EOP resources in a more extensive system for media monitoring (Karpowitz, 2009). Scholars have repeatedly described Nixon as the originator of the White House “news summary” (Grossman & Kumar, 1981; Kumar & Sullivan, 2003).

2. The Historical Development of White House News Summaries (1968-2000)

While historical records often refer to the “news summary” as if it was one single report, White House media monitoring encompassed not only a narrative summary of the news, but also clipbooks, wire compilations, and other specialized reports. Confusingly, the term “news summary” is sometimes used to describe the White House’s broader media monitoring operation, rather than a single report. In some periods, the summary itself was the primary product; in others, it functioned alongside a packet of full-text clips or a wider set of supporting materials. To understand how presidents and their staffs monitored the press, it is therefore necessary to consider the broader information system for collecting, filtering, and circulating politically relevant news.

During this early period, each administration had to design its own system for monitoring news. When Ken Chitester, Director of the Office of News Analysis from 1993-94, arrived in the Office of News Analysis, he describes an office that had been stripped to bare and left empty by the prior administration (Chitester, 1997, p. 37). Each new administration had to build its own news summary capability.

Differences in presidential preferences, organizational resources, and technology produced substantial variation in White House media monitoring systems. These factors shaped how news was collected and processed, influencing which sources were monitored and how clips were gathered, sorted, and organized. They also affected the scope, content, and audience of the reports themselves.

2.1 Early Administrative Discontinuity: Richard Nixon through George H. W. Bush

The expansion of White House media monitoring under Nixon illustrates how presidents tailor the news summary based on their preferences and needs. According to Christopher F. Karpowitz’s excellent article on Nixon’s news summaries, Nixon intended for his media monitoring system to be a complete substitute for all other media coverage. He consciously avoided directly reading or watching news, believing that direct consumption would introduce bias into his information environment. However, Karpowitz (2009) provides compelling evidence that Nixon’s isolation from the media opened him up to manipulation by the staffers who controlled his news summaries. In fact, under his successors, Ford and Carter, the news summary operation was modified with the goal of producing “a neutral reflection of what actually appears in the media” (Grossman & Kumar, 1981, p. 103). Additionally, while Nixon’s successors continued to invest in systematic media monitoring, they supplemented their news summaries with direct news consumption.³

Like Nixon, Jimmy Carter’s media habits also shaped his administration’s news summaries, albeit with very different results. While most presidents focused news collection on

³See the following sources: Ford (Ford, 1976; Fuller, 2014), Carter (Powell, 1981), Reagan (Fuller, 2014), George H.W. Bush (The Christian Science Monitor, 2000), and Clinton (The Christian Science Monitor, 2000). Prior presidents also directly consumed news, including Nixon’s immediate predecessors, Lyndon B. Johnson and John F. Kennedy (Fuller, 2014; The Christian Science Monitor, 2000).

national sources⁴ and Washington media,⁵ Carter took a different approach. Unlike presidents before or since, Carter’s news summaries excluded the New York Times, Washington Post, and other Washington media because Carter separately read those papers every morning (Powell, 1981). His administration took the opposite approach from Nixon. His briefing “was intended not to be the President’s only source of information from the press” (Powell, 1981).

Carter’s personal preference for evening summaries also contributed to their form. Unlike other presidents, Carter preferred to read his briefing at night, so the summaries were produced during the day and finished by the early evening (Powell, 1981). Given when papers went to press, clips from evening editions of papers would be fresher and morning editions would be staler. Other presidents did the opposite. They had staff work overnight to produce morning news summaries with fresh clips from the morning editions of papers. According to Carter’s Press Secretary, the president’s preference for evening summaries contributed to why they did not include major national and Washington papers and why Carter supplemented the news summaries with full copies of the morning editions of these papers (Powell, 1981). Carter’s news summaries therefore cannot be understood in isolation. Their content is dictated by a broader information system in which the president relied on both an evening summary and direct access to major morning newspapers.

Despite very different approaches, Nixon and Carter’s news summaries were both tailored to an audience of one: the president. In later administrations, White House news reports would be targeted at a broader audience. However, even in this early period, news summary circulation went far beyond the president. Over Nixon’s first term, distribution expanded from a handful of senior staff in 1969 to nearly 100 people by 1972, including the Cabinet and various agencies in the executive branch (Nixon Foundation, 2010). While Nixon’s staff used the summary to stay broadly informed, it was especially valuable because of its influence on Nixon: “The senior staff used news summaries to stay informed, but perhaps more importantly hoped to stay a half step ahead of the president” (Nixon Foundation, 2010). Similarly, despite being “designed entirely for the President’s daily reading,” Carter’s news summaries were regularly circulated to several hundred White House staff and considered “a very important source of information for everybody around the White House” (Powell, 1981). The distribution list started at about 120 and grew until it was capped at 200 (Powell, 1981). In 1983, Ronald Reagan’s news summaries were distributed about to about 175 staffers (Pugh, 1993).

A president’s interests and the political environment can also shape news collection. Richard Nixon and George H.W. Bush both had systems for monitoring foreign news outlets (Cooper, 2018; Karpowitz, 2009). During George H.W. Bush’s administration, “U.S. embassies around the world would dutifully provide our team with translations of foreign coverage” (Cooper, 2018). Later presidents like Bill Clinton, George W. Bush, and Barack Obama would have relatively little foreign press content in their news summaries. While it is tempting to connect this to the end of the Cold War, Reagan’s news summaries complicate a Cold War explanation. Based on a limited review of his news summaries, Reagan’s news summaries contained little foreign press coverage.⁶ Explaining the presence of international

⁴Common national sources include the New York Times and Wall Street Journal.

⁵Common Washington media include the Washington Post and Washington Times.

⁶Recently, some of Reagan’s news summaries were digitized and posted by the Reagan presidential library

news outlets in presidential news summaries requires considering other factors, including how each administration’s news summaries fit into a larger information ecosystem.

During some administrations, news summaries served a relatively narrow role. Compared to other presidents, Reagan’s news summaries are strikingly narrow in scope. According to a staffer in 1983, Reagan’s news summaries only contained stories that were directly about the administration, and they only collected clips from five wire services and four papers (Pugh, 1993).⁷ By 1984-1987, Reagan’s news summaries regularly included content from the major broadcast networks (ABC, NBC, CBS) as well but remained overwhelmingly composed of articles from the same nine print sources. Other sources were almost exclusively relegated to short 1-2 page inserts added at the back of some, but not all, of the news summaries.⁸

In comparison, news summaries had a much larger scope under the Carter’s administration. According to his staff, Carter’s summaries were designed to (i) “give him an idea of what was going on in the rest of the country in terms of trends and news events that might not yet be covered in Washington, and in terms of editorial comment from other papers, a variety of voices” and (ii) “give some idea of how the things that were going on in Washington were being portrayed through the outlets that reached the largest numbers of people” (Powell, 1981). To achieve this goal, Carter’s team regularly reviewed “about a hundred and twenty newspapers among us from all over the country, plus looking at the wire services” (Powell, 1981).⁹

The sophistication of media monitoring under the Carter administration led the news summary staff to play a larger role in the White House. While designed for a narrow purpose, over time, the Carter media monitoring operation began to take on a larger research role (Powell, 1981):

People gradually learned that it was useful to have all those newspapers lying around, and folks would call from different offices and say, You know, we’re working on a project on water policy, and we want to know what you see about drought and flooding and water problems or political problems over water in the western newspapers. Can you watch it for two weeks and then tell us what you get? And people would compile those sorts of things.

Over time, their research function expanded and influenced the operations of the office

(see Appendix A.2 for details). I reviewed 15 news summaries from June 1984 to August 1987. Occasionally, his briefings would contain a page of excerpts from foreign press, but these clips were not integrated into the main news summary and put at the very end of the briefing. Only five of fifteen news summaries contained “Foreign Media Reaction” sections. All but one example had only one page of foreign press clips, and the only exception had two pages of foreign press clips.

⁷Specifically, the article describes monitoring five wire services and the following papers: The Washington Post, New York Times, Washington Times, and Wall Street Journal (Pugh, 1993).

⁸See prior discussion of foreign press in Reagan’s news summaries and Appendix A.2.2. Out of fifteen summaries, eight had a one to two page section with local and national editorials. In each case, local clips were limited to editorial sections at the end of the summary.

⁹Carter’s staff would rotate through different papers; they didn’t use the same newspapers and editorial sources every day (Carter, 1978). On an average day, they reviewed 30-40 newspapers: “Miss Townsend...heads a staff of five that scans 30 to 40 newspapers and the morning and evening network news and assembles a 10- to 15-page typed summary designed to give the President “a feeling for events going on in the country” (UPI, 1977).

(Powell, 1981).

News summary content is also affected by other news reports and information sources. As discussed previously, White House media monitoring often produced multiple reports. In addition to a narrative summary, they created a variety of clipbooks, hourly updates, and weekly roundups.¹⁰ In some cases, news covered in a separate report would be excluded from the main summary. For example, when political cartoons or magazine articles are compiled into separate reports, they are sometimes omitted from the main news summary.¹¹

2.2 Clinton as a Transitional Case

Media monitoring during the Clinton administration was strongly shaped by the emergence of the internet and personal computers. Online news led to information overload, even in the early days of the internet. In the 1990s, staffers experienced rapid changes to news accessibility, distribution, and production, which overwhelmed them with stories at all hours of the day. For the most part, Clinton's Office of News Analysis retained key features of the earlier in-house model: a small staff, a labor-intensive clipping operation, and a limited set of sources. While retaining this earlier model, Clinton's staff struggled to adapt to a rapidly changing media environment and take advantage of new technology. As a result, the Clinton years capture how major technological changes challenged older forms of White House media monitoring.

During Clinton's administration, White House news reports were produced by the White House Office of News Analysis. The office was in "in charge of monitoring all of the news coverage of the President and summarizing it for White House staff" (Chitester, 1997, p. 37). Each morning, they created a 150-200 page set of newspaper clippings and a 4-7 page narrative news summary. They also sent out wire updates and produced separate weekly reports for magazines, editorials, and political cartoons.¹² Later, in Clinton's second term, the office would also produce a weekly specialized news report. While additional analysis will be required to determine what portion of Clinton's news summaries and clipbooks contain coverage of the president, not every article mentions the president.¹³

The shorter news narrative was delivered to personnel each weekday morning. For the first time, a news summary could be distributed electronically, partly but not completely eliminating bottlenecks responsible for capping distribution in the past. Unlike the clips, it was possible to distribute these reports electronically over email and an electronic "bulletin board" accessible to everyone at the White House. Tracking software showed that many staffers read the Office's electronic news reports. During one month, the average readership

¹⁰Many presidents had other reports. For example, Nixon had weekly magazine reports (Karpowitz, 2009). Carter had a separate weekly magazine report (Powell, 1981). George H.W. Bush also receive continuous news updates throughout the day (Cooper, 2018).

¹¹While Carter had political cartoons in his daily news summary (Powell, 1981), Clinton's cartoons were placed in a separate 'Clintoon' report. Clinton had a separate report for magazine articles whereas George W. Bush and Obama had magazine articles placed directly in their daily news summaries.

¹²For examples of Clinton's reports for magazines, editorials, and political cartoons ('Clintoons') can be found in Ira Magaziner's Files, 1993-1994 (National Archives Identifier 12092985) and David Kusnet's Files, 1993-1994 (National Archives Identifier 7431944).

¹³For example, in the June 11, 1999 clipbook, there is an article on a recent Supreme Court decision about police policy in Chicago (p. 9).

exceeded 168 per day (Chitester, 1997, pp. 42, 59). Compared to prior administrations, fewer resources seem to have been devoted to the news summaries. According to Ken Chitester, Director of the Office of News Analysis, a single staff member working overnight wrote all of the daily news summaries (Chitester, 1997, p. 59). It is also possible that the summaries were not produced after 1994. The Clinton library only located electronic records of emailed summaries from 1993-1994, raising the possibility that the summaries were discontinued (for details, see Appendix A.2).

While the summaries could be distributed electronically, the clips were only available in hardcopy. Most clips were cut out of printed newspapers. Like prior administrations, the time required to photocopy the clips limited their distribution (Chitester, 1997, p. 61). Unlike the news summary, the clips were only available to the president and senior White House staff (Kumar & Sullivan, 2003). On weekdays, the Office distributed about 125 copies of the news clips. Weekend news clips were shorter and only delivered to several dozen people (Chitester, 1997, p. 59).

Although news reports provided valuable information to White House staff,¹⁴ receiving the clips also became a status symbol. According to Ken Chitester, “It was amazing how seriously people took the packages of news clippings we produced each morning. A lot of folks who got them didn’t even need them—they just wanted to be on the distribution list because somebody else with a similar title was, and they didn’t want to be left out” (Chitester, 1997, pp. 62–62). This status was partly a byproduct of the technology used to produce and distribute news reports. Before email and digital distribution, each additional recipient imposed printing and delivery costs, which forced administrators to limit circulation. As a result, inclusion on the distribution list became a visible marker of standing within the White House. Unsurprisingly, these technological constraints produced similar dynamics during prior administrations. An official from the Carter administration recalled, “the news summary, the original one that came from the White House, had a Carter green logo. When people would want to add on to the subscription list, we would tell them, Feel free to copy it. Well, that wasn’t the same thing, because then you had a black cover where it said, The White House News Summary, whereas insiders would have the green one” (Powell, 1981).

By 1996, the Clinton administration made other changes to media monitoring. Most notably, the scope of the clipbooks shrank dramatically. During his first term, daily news reports contained clips from over 50 news sources. The new daily reports only contained clips from 11 sources. Instead of including a rotating selection of local newspapers in the daily news report, the office created a new weekly report. This new weekly report had additional local news sources¹⁵ and a section for ‘specialized news,’ which included outlets affiliated with various ethnic groups, gender/sexuality groups, religious groups, and trades.¹⁶

¹⁴For examples, see Barabak & Helfand (2010) and Powell (1981). Annotations on archived copies of news reports also show that the reports were actively reviewed by White House personnel. For examples, see Ira Magaziner’s Files, 1993–1994 (National Archives Identifier 12092985) and David Kusnet’s Files, 1993–1994 (National Archives Identifier 7431944). Both can be found in collection WJC-TFNHC: Records of the Task Force on National Health Care (Clinton Administration).

¹⁵In the local and specialized reports from 1999, the following local papers appear at least once: Boston Globe, Miami Herald, Philadelphia Inquirer, Arkansas Democrat Gazette, Detroit Free Press, St. Louis Post Dispatch, Houston Chronicle, San Francisco Chronicle, and Seattle Times.

¹⁶In the specialized reports from 1999, the following sections appear at least once: African-American, Asian American, Latino/Hispanic, Native American, European Ethnic, Asian, Gay/ Lesbian, Women’s Issues,

While these new reports had far fewer local news sources, they had a uniquely high number of other specialized sources. Tellingly, Jimmy Carter was once confronted for having so little Hispanic news in his news summaries.¹⁷ Based on my review of Bush and Obama news reports (see Appendix A.2 for more details), neither included much news from ethnic, LGBTQ, or religious news outlets.

Unlike some prior administrations, Clinton's news reports were intended for White House staff broadly, not just the president. The intended audience of the clips is made explicit in a disclaimer included with the daily news clips package, which states that the clips were "prepared by the White House office to bring News items of interest to the attention of key personnel for use in their Official capacities."¹⁸

Although news reports had a wide audience, they remained an important source of information for President Clinton. Staff repeatedly commented on Clinton's interest in the news and the daily clipbook. In a 1995 press briefing, a White House spokeswoman remarked that "in the morning, [Clinton] gets news clips, and he reads them" (Terzano, 1994). As Press Secretary Mike McCurry explained in 1997, the president sometimes noticed "the most amazingly obscure piece of journalism that you could imagine" (McCurry, 1997). Even when Clinton did not have time to read every article, the summary and his staff helped him stay up to date on news (McCurry, 1997).

Despite its central role in informing both staff and the president, the Office of News Analysis struggled to stay on top of the news. The office's difficulties reflected both persistent staffing constraints and the challenge of adapting older media-monitoring practices to a changing information environment. By the 1990s, the volume of available information was growing rapidly while new technologies were transforming how news could be collected and distributed. The office occupied an awkward position between the old world of manually assembled clipbooks and the emerging world of electronic news distribution. As a result, staff faced a growing flood of news content while trying to incorporate unfamiliar technologies into an existing workflow.

Part of this challenge involved persistent personnel shortages. According to Ken Chitester, the staff of the office was downsized from five full-time staff at the end of the George H.W. Bush administration to three full-time staff at the beginning of the Clinton administration (Chitester, 1997, p. 37).¹⁹ Possibly as a response to its limited resources, the Office of News Analysis embraced a narrower role within the White House. While Carter's media monitoring staff routinely handled various research requests, Clinton's staff referred

Social Issues, Religious, and Trades.

¹⁷In the conference, a reporter asked whether Carter would consider including more Hispanic media and mentioned that Carter's staff claimed that there "wasn't a staffer in the White House who could cull the information from the Hispanic media" (Carter, 1978). Carter acknowledged that "we could use more information from the Spanish-speaking community" but also defended their news summary operation: "We do use all three networks and summarize their evening news program, and we do use the lead stories from AP and UPI. That's the only thing that's included every day. The rest of the time they come from a very wide range of sources, sometimes little tiny newspapers, sometimes Spanish-Hispanic-American newspapers, sometimes black-owned newspapers" (Carter, 1978).

¹⁸For an example, see the "White House News Report, Wednesday, August 4, 1993, Morning Edition."

¹⁹Note that other sources report slightly different staffing numbers. In 1993, Clinton's first Director of the Office of News Analysis told the Harvard Crimson that the staff had halved from eight during the Bush administration to four under Clinton (Gammill, 1993).

such requests to other offices, freeing the Office of News Analysis to focus on producing its regular media reports (Chitester, 1997, p. 62). Similarly, they used technology to shift media monitoring responsibilities to other offices. According to Chitester, “The goal was for Presidential aides or their assistants to be able to check for wire stories in their area of responsibility and hopefully take some of the load off of our understaffed Office of News Analysis” (Chitester, 1997, p. 42).

Compounding staff shortages, the office also struggled to adapt to a changing media environment. Technological advances made it possible to electronically deliver news directly to the White House at all hours of the day.²⁰ The office’s first Director, Keith O. Boykin, had a new computer system installed right away (Gammill, 1993). By December 1994, the White House had fifteen workstations that could access wire services. This system also allowed Chitester to email “four daily compilations of wire stories directly to the bulletin board on our computer system so everybody at the White House could scroll through them” (Chitester, 1997, p. 42).

Computers also impacted how clips were collected. As early as 199X, the first printed articles appear in the clipbooks. By 1996, the Press Secretary had access to an electronic clipping service called “News Edge” (Fetig, 1999).²¹ The White House also had access to services like Lexis Nexis, another database of news articles.²² Despite access to these services, most clips continued to be collected by hand from print copies of newspapers.

Importantly, online article databases enabled new methods for finding and organizing clips and changed the economics of media monitoring. Physically cutting out clips from newspapers required someone to read every article and determine whether it was relevant. In contrast, digital files could be searched with computers, allowing for time-intensive tasks to be automated. Suddenly, the marginal cost of collecting news was far lower if online articles were available. This likely pushed the White House towards papers that happened to be available online before the clips packet needed to be circulated. As discussed previously, by 1996, the format of clipbooks had changed. Daily news reports only included the major national sources, papers from Washington DC, and three local/regional papers.²³ Tellingly, the only West Coast Paper, the Los Angeles Times, and the three local papers were all printed, rather than cut out of newspapers.

In their book on White House transitions, Martha Joynt Kumar and Terry Sullivan

²⁰Before the internet, the White House had an older system for electronically transmitting news summaries to the President when he traveled, but it was cumbersome. During George H.W. Bush’s administration, there was “an Air Force officer accompanied the President, responsible for the secure system that allowed us to directly transmit our reports in a pre-internet world” (Cooper, 2018).

²¹In 1997, the company that offered this service, Desktop Data Inc., merged with another company to form NewsEdge Corp. At that time, the “combined company will have more than 2,000 information sources under license, delivering about 50,000 stories daily to more than 840,000 readers” (Dow Jones Newswires, 1997). The service was also described as particularly expensive and potentially threatened by upcoming free services (Rigdon, 1996).

²²For evidence of Lexis Nexis use, see the National Archive files named “Lexis-Nexis” (NAID: 52874518) and “Lexis-Nexis Awareness Search Hillary Rodham Clinton, February 18, 1998” (NAID: 26415290).

²³Specifically, the clipbooks included the following sources: major national sources (wire reports, TV headlines, New York Times, Wall Street Journal, USA Today, Los Angeles Times), papers from Washington DC (Washington Post, Washington Times), and papers that could be accessed via Lexis Nexis (Chicago Tribune, Knight-Ridder, Dallas Morning News). In the 1990s, Knight-Ridder owned dozens of local and regional papers.

(2003) predicted that the internet would reduce the importance of the White House news summary: “In a sense, the news summary has been transformed and downgraded in importance by the advent of newspapers found on the Internet. While in earlier times the White House would send someone down to the Post for the early, or ‘Bull Dog,’ edition released late at night, today the staff view stories online” (p. 244). Given the reduced scope of centralized media monitoring during the Clinton administration, it is easy to see how they came to this conclusion. However, changing technology did not reduce the White House’s demand for information. While undermining the old system of media monitoring, the internet also produced new challenges that necessitated new solutions. Rather than abandon news summaries, technology pushed White House media monitoring to evolve.

In summary, the Clinton years were a transitional period marked by tension between an inherited media monitoring system and a rapidly changing information environment. Despite attempts to incorporate new technology, they never fully integrated these tools into their media monitoring system. Faced with electronic delivery, new clipping services, staffing constraints, and a widening media environment, the office moved away from producing a single comprehensive news report. Instead, they experimented with various spin off reports, encouraged other offices to search online news directly, and reduced the scope of their primary media monitoring report. Even in its last years, the administration relied extensively on a labor-intensive system of manually reviewing and cutting clips from major newspapers.

3. The Bulletin Era and the Institutionalization of Greater Continuity (2001-2025)

A major institutional break occurred when George W. Bush took office in 2001 (Kumar & Sullivan, 2003). Beginning that year, production of the White House news summary was outsourced to a private contractor, Bulletin Intelligence (“Bulletin”).²⁴ Bulletin went on to produce news summaries for every subsequent administration. Its contract with the Executive Office of the President (EOP) extended through the Obama, Trump, and Biden administrations, creating a degree of continuity that had been largely absent in the earlier period. Across these administrations, Bulletin’s reports retained a broadly similar format and production process. As a result of this continuity, differences across administrations are less likely to reflect changes in how the reports were produced and more likely to reflect differences in presidential priorities, media environments, and technology.

To understand the purpose and audience of the White House News Summaries (WHNS) and News Clips (WHNC) produced by Bulletin, I submitted a Freedom of Information Request (FOIA) for all email correspondence between Bulletin and the Bush White House before March 31, 2001 (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).²⁵ I also searched USA Spending,

²⁴Bulletin Intelligence has gone through several name changes over the years. In the 2000s, it was also known as Bulletin News Network Incorporated. Its name changed again after it was acquired by Cision, Inc in 2017 (Bulletin Intelligence, 2025). The ‘Bulletin Intelligence’ name continued to be used on Cision products before being phased out in recent years. For simplicity, I will use the name ‘Bulletin’ to refer to the company before and after the merger.

²⁵I also submitted a similar request to the Obama library for the emails between the White House and Bulletin as well (24-70035-F, 24-70034-F). As of June 2026, this request is still being processed.

a database of federal spending information, for payments from the Executive Office of the President (EOP) to Bulletin. Lastly, I reviewed SAM.gov for contract solicitations and similar documents related to White House media monitoring (see the Appendix A.1 for more details). I also collected a sample of 320 WHNC and 205 WHNS (see Appendix A.2 for details).

In examining Bulletin’s contract with the White House, I relied extensively on four sets of documents: the contract proposal from Bulletin Intelligence in 2001 and three contract solicitations in 2010, 2018, and 2021.²⁶ Contract solicitations contain multiple documents, including a Statements of Work (SOW), which describes the purpose, scope and requirements for a contract.

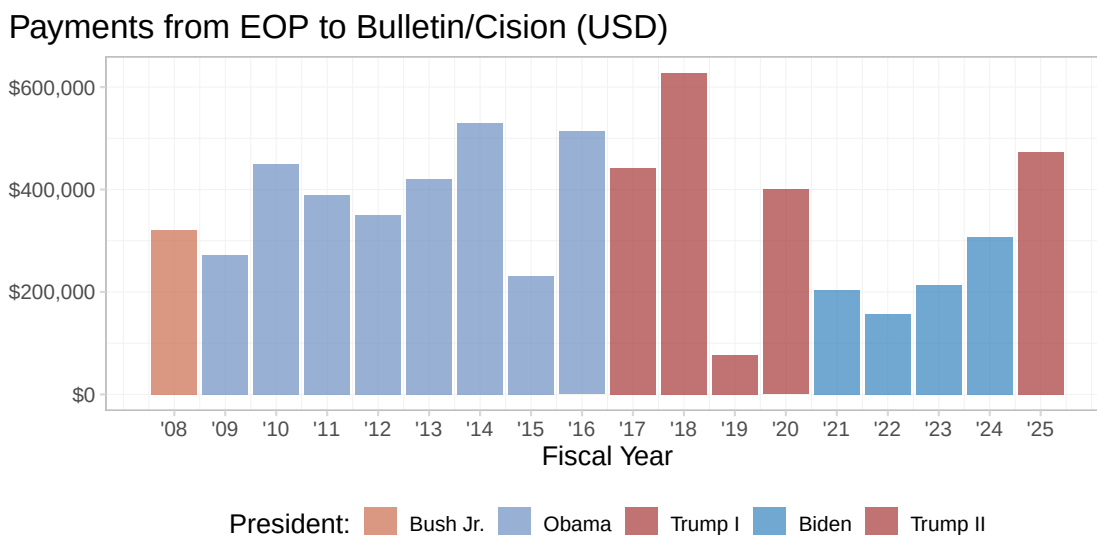


Figure 1: Total obligations by the Executive Office of the President (EOP) to Bulletin News Network Incorporated, Bulletin Intelligence LLC, and Cision US Inc. Data from USA Spending.

From 2008 to 2025, the White House paid Bulletin an average of \$354,430 per year (see Figure 1).²⁷ USA Spending does not have data before this period. While Figure 1 shows fluctuations in White House spending on Bulletin’s media monitoring services, these changes in spending are difficult to interpret without further data collection and analysis. First, the yearly fluctuations are partly an artifact of how USA Spending aggregates the data.²⁸ Second, the scope of the contracts changed over time.

Specifically, the number of reports and services covered by the Bulletin contract increased over time. The original contract only included the main WHNS and WHNC. The total first

²⁶The 2001 proposal was produced in response to Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F. The other documents were attached to contract solicitations on SAM.gov (notice nos. OAS-GEN-R-10-0101, OND-GEN-D-18-0052, and 11316021Q0005EOP). For additional details about these documents, see Appendix A.1.

²⁷Remarkably, despite his administration’s threats to cut other news services (Basu & Caputo, 2025; Guardian Staff, 2025; Kornfield et al., 2025), Trump’s administration has continued to renew the Bulletin contract. EOP finalized a new \$321,551 contract with Cision for “NEWS CLIPS/BRIEFING” in September 2025. See USA spending page for Blanket Purchase Agreement (BPA) Call, PIID 11316025F0013WHO.

²⁸According to USA Spending’s website: “Obligations across the life of the award are aggregated and displayed under the latest month, quarter, or year of the latest transaction action date for each award.”

year cost for 2001 was around \$142,500.²⁹ By 2018, Bulletin’s EOP contract included a mid-day and evening edition of the WHNS, covered news reports for at least two additional EOP components,³⁰ and authorized other EOP components to also order off the Blanket Purchase Agreement (BPA).³¹ The 2018 and 2021 contracts also required an analytics dashboard with news media and social-media metrics.

3.1 Why Privatize News Summaries?

Why did the Bush administration break with the prior six presidents and outsource its news summaries? Unfortunately, none of the documents that I reviewed provide a clear answer. However, there were likely several factors.

First, an ideological commitment to privatization may have spurred the Bush administration to outsource the news summary. Early in his administration, Bush announced plans for making almost half of all government jobs eligible for outsourcing (Chen, 2002). Compared to other presidents, Bush was particularly aggressive in pushing public-private competitions for jobs and “included it as one component of the President’s Management Agenda” (Halchin, 2012). Over his administration, payments to government contractors doubled (Zwerdling, 2008, p. 2).

Second, the early leaders of Bulletin had experience reading and producing White House news summaries. Many of Bulletin’s early leaders worked for Ronald Reagan and George H.W. Bush. One of its editors, Bruce Wilmot, served in both administrations as the White House Director of News Summary and Audio Services.³² Bulletin’s promotional material emphasizes the fact that its “editorial staff is trained in politics, and applies a layer of seasoned human judgment to the technological underpinning of BNN information services.”³³

Third, and perhaps most importantly, the internet changed the economic calculus of media monitoring by creating economies of scale. Previously, there were companies like Burrelle’s Press Clipping Bureau that specialized in collecting and filing newspaper articles (Popp, 2014). However, it took time to read, index, retrieve, and send clips. To monitor breaking news, the White House had to review papers in real time and identify articles that met a narrow set of criteria. In contrast, the internet and digital copies of articles made it possible to automate news collection, use keywords to quickly sort articles, and rapidly distribute summaries.

While the marginal cost of a new report was far lower than under manual clipping systems,

²⁹According to the 2001 draft proposal, “Bulletin News will provide the summary and clips package at only the cost required to hire the three additional writers and meet the new 6:00 a.m., 7-day-a-week deadline. The three workers will average \$45,000 per year, which means the monthly rate for these workers will be \$11,250. There will be an additional cost of \$7,500 for the first month for the overtime weekend duty for existing Bulletin News staff.”

³⁰The 2018 and 2021 contracts required separate reports for Office of the Vice President and Office of National Drug Control Policy.

³¹See the Statement of Work for the Solicitation for “Expert-edited Daily and Intra-day News Briefings” posted Sept. 14, 2018 (OND-GEN-D-18-0052).

³²See the draft proposal for Draft Proposal For White House News Summary and Clips Package, which is attached to an email from Paul Roellig to Vickers B. Meadows on February 16, 2001 (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

³³See the January 30, 2001 email from Mark Gabor to Brian Bravo (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

building digital news collection infrastructure required substantial upfront investment and continual maintenance. In 2001, Bulletin had a fairly sophisticated system of scraping news using “proprietary software, search-and-delivery engines, and web spiders.”³⁴ By the time that they began to produce the WHNS and WHNC, Bulletin had a decade of experience producing a popular electronic daily newsletter.³⁵ Although this existing product was not customized for individual clients, it helped fund systems and develop expertise that Bulletin later used to produce tailored news summaries for the White House.

Having already built the necessary news-gathering infrastructure, Bulletin could offer new products at a fraction of the cost. In their original proposal, Bulletin noted this explicitly: “The full cost associated with the production of such an in-depth news summary and clipping service, obviously, is far greater, but Bulletin News already has many of these costs covered through existing operations.”³⁶ Their contract proposal states that they would only charge the White House for the additional staff required to complete the White House news reports.

Between lowering barriers to publication and making traditional media more accessible, the internet also increased pressure to monitor larger quantities of news. Scholars of political communication and journalism have long argued that the rise of cable television, online news, and later social media fragmented audiences and accelerated the news cycle [Chadwick (2017); prior2007post]. Instead of a relatively stable media environment dominated by a handful of national newspapers and broadcast networks, political actors increasingly confronted a growing number of outlets operating on a 24-hour news cycle. The rise of continuous news coverage created what one Clinton aide described as a “giant monster” that had to be continually fed (O’Mara, 2015, p. 184). For the White House, these developments increased the value of systematic media monitoring. The challenge was no longer simply collecting a small number of influential stories each morning, but identifying relevant information from an expanding and increasingly fragmented information environment.

Bulletin’s own marketing emphasizes this challenge. In its press releases, Bulletin has described itself as “The perfect antidote to information overload” (Bulletin Intelligence, 2014). Acquiring Bulletin Intelligence, Cision shared a similar sentiment, describing how “In an era of excess information and the 24/7 news cycle, the addition of Bulletin’s world-class analyst services bolsters our ability to provide data-driven insights that today’s executives need to make critical business decisions” (Cision Ltd., 2017).

3.2 How Bulletin Produced the News Summary

The 2001 proposal and the 2010, 2018, and 2021 contract solicitations all describe a similar process for producing the news summaries: (1) find and review news clips, (2) identify relevant information in the clips, (3) write short summaries of the relevant information in

³⁴See email from Mark Gabor to Brian Bravo dated January 30, 2001 (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

³⁵See the draft proposal for Draft Proposal For White House News Summary and Clips Package, which is attached to an email from Paul Roellig to Vickers B. Meadows on February 16, 2001 (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F). See also the email from Mark Gabor to Brian Bravo dated January 30, 2001 (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

³⁶See the draft proposal for Draft Proposal For White House News Summary and Clips Package, which is attached to an email from Paul Roellig to Vickers B. Meadows on February 16, 2001 (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

articles, remove redundant information, and “weave the remaining (important) information such that it reads as a single story rather than subsets of the myriad stories on the same topic” (2021 SOW, p. 2-3).

The first stage involved identifying and collecting relevant news coverage. In its original proposal, Bulletin lists its main sources, which include all major TV networks, wire services, and major papers.³⁷ In later contracts, the list of sources would expand to include “all major (and many smaller) daily newspapers, national television and cable news, most local television markets, newsweeklies, relevant magazines and journals, internet sites, specialty press, etc.” (2021 SOW, p. 2). Additionally, Bulletin was expected to expand the scope of its search “when analysts determine a source outside the core list has additional important information or when, for example, the President travels, in which case the White House News Summary will include deeper coverage from outlets in that market” (2021 SOW, p. 2).

Many day-to-day editorial judgments were made by Bulletin independently, but the White House had input into key decisions. Contract solicitations required that contractors be able to, on short notice, “change the topics to be covered; the deadlines; the topic sections; the format of the briefing; etc. as directed” (2010 SOW, p. 3; see also 2021 SOW, p. 3; and 2018 SOW, p. 4). Emails between Bulletin and the Bush administration contain evidence of numerous adjustments requested by the Bush administration. In February 2001, the White House asked for numerous modifications to the news summaries, including an early edition for the President’s Chief of Staff, the addition of a section with “summaries of relevant editorials from the NYT, WP, WSJ and LAT,” and putting “Bush news” first in the WHNS.³⁸

In other emails, White House requests involve specific stages of news summary production. In various emails, the White House requests changes to the first stage by specifying particular sources to be added to the briefings. At one point, the White House provided a list of columnists for Bulletin to monitor.³⁹ In other emails, they discuss what local sources the administration wants added to the first stage.⁴⁰

Occasionally, the White House would provide direct input into the second stage by asking for a specific clip to be included in the next day’s reports. In the first two-and-a-half months of the Bush administration, this occurred at least twice. In one case, the clip was requested over email.⁴¹ In the other case, an email apologizes for missing a clip requested by voicemail.⁴² If other clips were requested only by phone, they would not appear in the

³⁷The original proposal included the following papers: “newspapers regularly covered within the news summary will be the Washington Post, Wall Street Journal, New York Times, Washington Times, USA Today, Los Angeles Times, Detroit News, New York Post, Baltimore Sun, Miami Herald, Chicago Tribune, Seattle Post-Intelligencer, Atlanta Constitution-Journal, and the Boston Globe. In addition, Bulletin News will include coverage of unique or breaking stories from hundreds of other regional and overseas papers, Congressional Quarterly and the major newsweeklies” (p. 1).

³⁸See the February 14, 2001 04:18:11 PM email from Paul Roellig to Blake Gottesman (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

³⁹See the February 14, 2001 04:18:11 PM email from Paul Roellig to Blake Gottesman (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

⁴⁰See proposal attached to the February 7, 2001 16:14:01 email from Paul Roellig to William T. Griffin (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F). For a list of requested local papers, see Appendix A.3.

⁴¹See the March 15, 2001 emails between Paul Roellig and Brian Bravo (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

⁴²See the February 21, 2001 emails between Paul Roellig and Brian Bravo (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-

surviving email correspondence, making it difficult to determine how often such requests occurred.

The topic sections in a report affect both steps two and three by defining what information is important. Because they are determined by the White House, the topic sections in a report can tell us about how presidential input and external events shape the news summaries. While many sections stay constant across administrations, presidential interests are reflected in the topic sections. Sometimes sections reflect major personal or political concerns. From 2002-2004, the Bush administration had a section called “Corporate Scandal News,” which was mostly Enron coverage (see also Benke, 2018). In 2015, the Obama administration added “National Policing Debate News” as a section. Other times, temporary sections reflecting major events were added. For example, after the Deepwater Horizon disaster in 2010, a section called “Oil Spill” was temporarily added to the WHNS.

In addition to describing similar procedures, the contract documents justify needing the news summaries using similar, albeit vague, language. The 2010 contract solicitation explains that “In furtherance of the EOP’s mission, senior officials shall start each day fully informed regarding important news printed and broadcast nationwide. The EOP has determined that this can best be accomplished via an expert-edited briefing rather than full-text articles or computer-generated summaries” (2010 SOW, p.2). Similar language can be found in the ‘Purpose’ section of the 2018 solicitation: “The EOP is committed to providing its staff and components the latest news, headlines, and analysis [sic] that give subscribers rapid, accurate, and critical information via desktop and mobile devices, so that the EOP staff and its components are able to become acquainted with voluminous news information, quickly and efficiently, in order to execute critical and strategic planning and decision-making” (2018 SOW, p.1).

While some prior administrations focused primarily on coverage of the president, the contract documents all describe a broader scope for the Bulletin-produced news summaries. The most detailed description of the briefing scope comes from emails between Bulletin’s leaders and the Bush administration in 2001:⁴³

In doing the White House News Summary, we literally scan the universe for anything to do with politics and policy with a Washington impact. That includes issue areas affecting virtually all the Cabinet agencies...We also cover state level issues which are likely to have a national impact - e.g., the California electricity situation. It also includes stories specifically covering the President, Vice President, Cabinet officers, party officials of both parties, congressional leaders and members. The White House News Summary also keeps track of political developments in Washington and around the country, including Federal races (US House, US Senate, President) and major state races (primarily governors). In addition, we cover White House stories, including personnel developments, scandals, policy planning, management and administration. The news summary also keeps track of developments in Congress - policy, political, structural (e.g., committee restructuring), and personnel.

F).

⁴³See email dated February 1, 2001 4:01 PM, produced in response to Bush Library FOIA No. 2024-0154-F.

The later contract solicitations similarly require Bulletin to look beyond coverage of the president. For example, the solicitations require that contractors consider “various constituencies within the EOP” when determining the relevance of a story (2021 SOW, p. 2; 2018 SOW, p. 2; 2010 SOW, p. 4). Also, they all require a national news section “suitable to the needs of EOP officials who shall be kept aware of important developments affecting the federal government broadly so they may interact with peers in the Administration and Congress” (2010 SOW, p.3).

Taken together, the contracts and correspondence reveal a striking degree of continuity in how White House news summaries were produced. Across administrations, Bulletin relied on a similar process for collecting, selecting, and synthesizing information, even as the specific sources, topics, and stories changed over time. This continuity created a relatively stable institutional framework through which both White House priorities and external events could shape the content of the summaries.

3.3 What Changed

Although Bulletin’s basic approach to producing White House news summaries remained remarkably stable, the service continued to evolve. Changes in the media environment, advances in technology, and shifting White House needs altered the products Bulletin delivered and the tools it used to create them. Three developments are particularly important. First, the services covered by the contracts evolved. Second, technological change transformed both the production of the summaries and the broader media environment they were designed to monitor. Third, later contracts imposed fewer explicit requirements regarding analyst qualifications and the use of automated tools.

Table 1: White House News Monitoring Contract Documents

Contract Document	News Summary (WHNS)	News Clips (WHNC)	Analytics Dashboard	Social Media Analytics
2001 Proposal	X	X		
2005 Description*	X	X		
2010 SOW	X		X**	
2018 SOW	X		X	X
2021 SOW	X		X	X

* Only the contract description is available for the 2005 contract on SAM.gov.

** While not required, the The analytics dashboard is an optional service in the 2010 SOW.

*** For the 2001 proposal, see Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F. For the other documents, see the SAM.gov entries for the following following notice IDs EOPOA-25010 (2005), OAS-GEN-R-10-0101 (2010), OND-GEN-D-18-0052 (2018), and 11316021Q0005EOP (2021).

(1) Services provided by Bulletin — While all contracts require a WHNS, the other services vary. Table 1 summarizes the main services provided under each contract.⁴⁴ Bulletin’s 2001 proposal describes two documents that it would produce every day: a 15-20 page WHNS and a 75+ page WHNC, which would be a packet of full text news articles used to

⁴⁴Table 1 does not include additional reports for other EOP components (e.g. the Vice President News Summary), which are covered by the 2018 and 2021 SOW. Because of gaps in the available documentation, I could not determine whether other reports were included in the other contracts.

construct the WHNS. Eventually, the WHNC were dropped from the contract. The 2010, 2018, and 2021 contract documents do not require WHNC and the Obama library could not find any emailed copies after 2010.⁴⁵ Instead, links would be provided to full-text articles or video/audio clips.

Dropping the WHNC did not shrink Bulletin’s workload; instead, other services were added to the contract. By 2018, the Bulletin contract included additional midday and evening versions of the WHNS as well as an analytics dashboard. While the 2010 contract solicitations only requires one 25-30 page WHNS document, it invites contractors to propose an additional service similar to the ‘analytics dashboard’ that appear as requirements in the 2018 and 2021 SOW.⁴⁶ Both the 2018 and 2021 solicitations provide detailed requirements for this dashboard, requiring that it provide metrics for stories “that mention the White House in conjunction with a topic of interest to the White House” (2018 SOW, p. 4). Unlike the WHNS, the contractor was expected to use automated tools (including sentiment analysis) for this product. The 2018 and 2021 solicitations also require a similar service for social media analytics.

While dropped by later administrations, there is some evidence that the Clips were particularly valued by the Bush administration, but the evidence is not conclusive. Most compellingly, the headings/sections were also changed far more frequently in the WHNC compared to the WHNS. In the WHNS and WHNC that I collected (see Appendix A.2), there are only 15 unique headings in the WHNS and 154 unique headings in the WHNC. Additionally, news coverage of Bush’s reading habits suggest that he preferred to skim headlines (Kinsley, 2003). On the other hand, the WHNC were sent to fewer people. According to a 2005 contract solicitation, the WHNC were circulated to approximately 100 staff and the WHNS were circulated to approximately 2500 staff.⁴⁷

(2) Technology – Technology had many effects on Bulletin’s operations. Internally, their technology for scraping and analyzing news evolved. Externally, access to online articles also improved.

In 2001, Bulletin was still developing their system for collecting news from websites. According to a February 2001 email chain about one of their several hundred code files, Bulletin’s web scraping scripts were fragile.⁴⁸ When discussing their script for scraping

⁴⁵According to a September 20, 2024 call with the Obama library, news clips were not emailed after 2010 but news summaries were emailed throughout the Obama administration. Requesting similar records from the Presidential Materials Division of the National Archives produced a similar result. In a September 25, 2024 email, Jessica Owens confirmed that the archivists were unable to find any WHNC in Joe Biden’s Vice Presidential records after October 1, 2010.

⁴⁶Per the 2010 SOW, “EOP desires a service to provide a perspective/view of media coverage trends over a time period designated by the end user. The capability shall provide a simple presentation tool that EOP officials can use to view the analytics in charts and graphs and in multiple slices, including daily, weekly and monthly trends, positive/negative coverage of national and regional stories from media types (print, television, internet, regional trends, etc.) Vendors are invited to address such a service in their responses and to provide separate pricing” (p. 5).

⁴⁷See the 2005 contract solicitation description, Notice ID EOPOA-25010.

⁴⁸The email contains additional details about the scraping script: “The page is updated by a vbscript in Autotask at around 6 a.m. each weekday morning. The vbscript pulls the paper feed in from Edev, formats and parses the news onto this page and each individual state page. I’d rate the reliability of the process at 85%. Five percent of problems with this page are related to Autotask crashes. The other 10 percent of the problems occur when the format of the feed changes. Even minor items, like an extra blank line can throw

USA Today's state-by-state wrap-up, an employee estimated "the reliability of the process at 85%." They struggled with key tools crashing and could not fully adapt to inconsistent website html formatting. Because of these challenges, they had to temporarily rely on less automated methods of collecting news, like having USA Today email Bulletin the articles directly. In the long term, Bulletin planned to rewrite its scripts.

Early news websites also imposed additional constraints. In 2001, critical news sources were not always available in time. In some cases, Bulletin arranged to receive early copies of stories.⁴⁹ In at least one case, Bulletin arranged for news websites to post stories earlier. On Feb 14, 2001, the White House told Bulletin that Andy Card⁵⁰ wanted editorials from the LA Times (LAT) by 5:55am every morning. At the time, LAT did not post its editorials early enough to be included. After they reached out, Bulletin reported that "The LA Times says they will speed up a new system to post their editorials on the Web in time for us to put them in the Summary, but this won't be in place until later this spring. In the meantime, they are working to find a way to have somebody email us the editorials once they are finished."⁵¹ On March 22, Bulletin reported, "The LAT just called to say they have redone their Web site system to allow their editorials to be posted by 5:00 a.m. They plan to overhaul the rest of the system over the next few months, but they did a temporary fix for us to get the editorials up early."⁵²

However, some sources, especially West Coast news outlets, were excluded from early WHNS because they were not posted early enough and Bulletin had not arranged for early delivery of their articles. In February 2001, the White House asked Bulletin whether they could produce a separate local news summary. In Bulletin's proposal, they proposed a later deadline (9:30 am) and emphasized the difficulties of acquiring local news:⁵³

Due to the inconsistent times the daily news is posted on the Web sites of a number of the local papers selected by the White House, it is difficult to accurately state what BNN [Bulletin] can do and at what cost...BNN has developed special relationships with a number of media companies and their reporters, however, which allows BNN to acquire by email and fax the relevant news stories before they are posted on the newspapers' Web sites. BNN would attempt to develop

the process off." See the email from Vin Narayanan to Kinsey S. Wilson on February 14, 2001 (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F). See also the email from Kinsey S. Wilson to Paul Roellig on February 14, 2001 (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

⁴⁹Bulletin arranged to receive an early copy of USA Today's state-by-state wrap-up via email. In addition to a fragile web scraper, Bulletin also struggled with when these articles were posted. According to a February 14, 2001 04:18:11 PM email from Paul Roellig to Blake Gottesman, "I've been informed that USA Today's state-by-state wrap-up is often not available on their Web site by 6:30 a.m. However, the editor in chief of USAToday.com is a friend, and I've asked him to consider the possibility of emailing us the file in time for its inclusion in the White House News Clips" (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

⁵⁰Andy Card was Bush's chief of staff. According to press coverage from the time, he was one of two people who would regularly brief Bush on the news each morning.

⁵¹See email from Paul Roellig to Blake Gottesman dated February 28, 2001 (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

⁵²See email from Paul Roellig to Blake Gottesman dated March 22, 2001 (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

⁵³See p.2 of the attachment to Paul Roellig's February 7, 2001 email to William T. Griffin (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

such relationships with the White House-selected newspapers, but cannot guarantee success.

Ultimately, the Bush administration chose not to pay for expanded local news coverage and continued to monitor local TV news “in-house.”⁵⁴ By 2010, the contracts had been expanded to cover local TV and print news.

In another instance, Bulletin advised against reaching out to the newspaper for an early copy. In February 2001, the White House requested that Bulletin add the Washington Post’s “Reliable Source” column, which was the paper’s society and gossip column. In their response, Bulletin noted that the column was usually published after their 6:30am deadline, but it advised against reaching out: “I would guess it is possible to call and ask them to email their stories in advance each day, but think it possible/likely that they would figure a way to mention this fact in their column. I’ll let you decide if the juice is worth the squeezing.”⁵⁵

Technology also influenced the kinds of media embedded in news summaries. Early Bulletin-produced WHNS did not contain links to audio or video clip. When citing a TV or radio source, Bulletin would either provide no link or it would provide a link to a print story on the broadcaster’s website. Around 2006, Bulletin started linking to videos hosted on its own servers. By 2010, links to video or audio clips became a contract requirement “[f]or broadcast stories in which reviewing the actual audio/video would be particularly useful” (2010 SOW, p. 3). The 2018 and 2021 solicitations contain similar language.

(3) Role of expertise and human review — Emphasis on expertise and human review appear in all of the contracts, but the contract language changes over time. All of the contract solicitations require using “human analyst/editors” and require “expert analysts to search, analyze, and filter the nation’s news” (2021 SOW, p. 1-2). However, early contracts have more stringent language around human review. For example, the 2010 solicitation requires that bidders submit “resumes/bios of relevant managers and editors/analysts” (2010 SOW, p. 4). While justifying this requirement, the solicitation states that expertise is needed because the reports “will be a significant source of information for EOP officials” (2010 SOW, p. 4). Later contracts do not require proof of employee expertise.

The 2018 and 2021 contract documents are also less clear about how automated tools can be used. In fact, the 2018 solicitation “requires the Contractor to utilize seasoned analysts with the potential to supplement with artificial-intelligence engines (i.e., Natural Language Processing) to deliver functionality cost-effectively, responsively, and with high quality” (2018 SOW, p. 1). In comparison, the 2010 solicitation emphasizes that its goals require “an expert-edited briefing rather than full-text articles or computer-generated summaries” (2010 SOW, p. 2). The 2010 solicitation also specifically limits overreliance on automated tools: “The vendor shall review important news outlets in hardcopy to identify stories not available electronically or news of interest to the EOP even if that news does not contain relevant keywords” (2010 SOW, p. 2). By the 2018 and 2020 solicitations, the language had been watered down: “The Contractor shall review important news outlets of interest to the EOP, even if that news does not contain relevant keywords” (2021 SOW, p. 2)

⁵⁴See email from William T. Griffin to Paul Roellig dated March 30, 2001 (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

⁵⁵See the February 14, 2001 04:18:11 PM email from Paul Roellig to Blake Gottesman (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

3.4 Audience and Circulation

While there is evidence that both Bush and Obama were consumers of the daily news reports, the reports were intended for a much broader audience and circulated widely. Officially, Bulletin’s 2001 contract only allowed distribution to a narrow list of people: “our deal with the White House calls for limited distribution of the White House News Summary to the President, his cabinet, and senior White House aides.”⁵⁶ However, as early as June 2001, the daily press briefings listserve contained 267 emails.⁵⁷ Later, the contract was updated to cover all EOP staff.⁵⁸

Unlike the other presidents since Nixon, George W. Bush was noted for consuming relatively little news.⁵⁹ According to press reports, he skimmed paper headlines and relied on a verbal briefing on the news from Andy Card and Condoleezza Rice each morning (Kinsley, 2003). Notably, the WHNC contained a table of contents with story headlines organized by topic, and internal emails reveal that Bush did get a copy of the WHNC every morning.⁶⁰ In fact, in March 2001, the White House scolded Bulletin for sending the Clips after 6:50 a.m., saying “today the clips barely made it to the President and Ari [his Press Secretary] before they left for Orlando, while both were expecting them before they left.”⁶¹ Additionally, internal emails reveal that Andy Card requested an early copy of the news summary by 5:55 a.m. each morning.⁶² Arranging for an early copy of the briefing suggests that Card valued it as an information source and needed it before he would verbally brief the president.

In contrast, Obama was widely regarded as an avid consumer of news. According to the Washington Post, Obama “reads his news summary each morning” and supplements his briefing with many other sources (Kornblut, 2009). Press coverage describes him “reading newspapers and magazines on his iPad and in print and dipping into blogs and Twitter” (Chozick, 2012). He began his days “reading the major newspapers, including his hometown Chicago Tribune and Chicago Sun-Times, mostly on his iPad through apps rather than their Web sites” (Chozick, 2012).

While I could not find any press coverage about Biden’s news habits during his presidency, Politico published a detailed story on his news consumption in December 2020, shortly before he took office (Lippman, 2020). A news summary or clipbook is the first source mentioned in the article: “Like many other politicians, Biden gets a clips package at 9 a.m. On a busy

⁵⁶See the February 1, 2001 email from Mark Gabor to Ashley E. Davis (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

⁵⁷See emails from Brian Bravo on June 3, 2001 (Bush Library FOIA 2021-0121-F).

⁵⁸See the 2005 contract solicitation description, Notice ID EOPOA-25010: “The WHNS is made available via the EOP intranet to all Executive Office of the President staff of approximately 2500 employees. The WHNS Clips are made available to approximately 100 White House staff and the ONDCPNB is made available to approximately 150 ONDCP staff.” See also the Question and Answer document attached to the 2021 solicitation for “News briefings summaries, news clips, or full texts of the articles or transcripts summaries,” Notice ID 11316021Q0005EOP. According to the answers, the “access to the daily news summary briefing on the IP-protected website...should be provided to all EOP staff, with an expected use by at least 250+ staff.” In comparison, approximately 50 staff were expected to use the Analytics Dashboard.

⁵⁹For evidence that Obama, Trump, and Biden all directly consumed news from various media outlets, see Chozick (2012); McGraw (2024); and Lippman (2020).

⁶⁰See the March 21, 2001 email from Brian Bravo to Mark Gabor (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

⁶¹See the March 21, 2001 email from Brian Bravo to Mark Gabor (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

⁶²See the February 14, 2001 email from Paul Roellig to Blake Gottesman (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

day, it can run up to 50 pages. On a slower day, it is more in the 15- to 20-page range.” Biden supplemented the clips package with other sources, including the New York Times and MSNBC’s Morning Joe.

While Donald Trump is most known for closely watching Fox News (Bump, 2017), his media diet extends to other television networks and print sources (Smith, 2017; VandeHei & Allen, 2017). I have been unable to find any evidence that he reads the Bulletin-produced WHNS, but his campaign staff were known for using clipping services to find articles for him to read (VandeHei & Allen, 2017). Supplementing clips printed by his staff, Trump also reads several print newspapers every morning, including the New York Times and New York Post [Smith (2017); McGraw (2024); allen2017trumpreads; Lippman (2019)].

During his first term, Trump’s aides put together a 1- to 2-inch thick folder with printed copies of new clips for him to read every morning (Lippman, 2019). Trump’s staff tried to control the clips that he would see, limiting his exposure to certain kinds of coverage. Others would try to go around this system to achieve their own political ends: “people would put articles on the president’s desk that were things he didn’t need to see, things that were meant to gin him up or get him mad at somebody...When somebody prints something off to hand to him, good or bad, that’s when you knew somebody was out for you. ‘Hey, how come there’s a copy here of a story from Breitbart?’ ” (Lippman, 2019).

In his second term, Trump’s staff continue to print clips for him to read, but he had additional means of accessing clips (McGraw, 2024). After leaving office in 2021, his news diet broadened as he began receiving article links directly on his phone from a large network of contacts.⁶³ He also began getting news through Truth Social, which was launched in 2022 (McGraw, 2024).

4. Conclusion

For more than half a century, presidents and their staffs have relied on systematic media monitoring to collect, summarize, and circulate politically relevant information. Yet the historical record reveals that the “White House news summary” was never a single, stable institution. Across administrations, media monitoring systems differed substantially in their intended audience, sources, organizational structure, and relationship to other information channels. Nixon’s summaries were designed to substitute for direct news consumption whereas Carter’s were tailored to complement it. Reagan’s summaries focused narrowly on coverage of the administration while George H. W. Bush’s media monitoring staff monitored a much wider range of domestic and international developments. Each administration’s media monitoring efforts reflected presidential preferences, organizational priorities, and the broader information environment.

The largest institutional break occurred in 2001, when the George W. Bush administration outsourced news collection and summary production to Bulletin Intelligence. Outsourcing created greater continuity than had existed under the earlier in-house model. The same contractor produced news summaries for five consecutive administrations, and contract

⁶³Specifically, after leaving office in 2021, Trump’s news diet expanded substantially because he “learned to use the iMessage feature on his iPhone” (McGraw, 2024). He now receives news links from a much broader set of people—anyone who has his number can text him articles or blog posts.

documents describe a remarkably consistent production process. Even so, White House media monitoring continued to evolve. Changes in technology, the growth of digital news, the fragmentation of the media environment, and shifting presidential priorities all shaped what information was collected, summarized, and distributed.

This history sheds light on the data generating process that produced White House news reports. The contents of these reports reflect both editorial decisions and the institutional systems that produced them. Differences across administrations may arise from changes in technology, organizational structure, distribution practices, reporting requirements, or presidential preferences rather than shifts in the underlying news environment alone. Understanding how these reports were created is therefore essential for interpreting what they contain.

More broadly, the history of White House media monitoring highlights a critical aspect of presidential governance. Presidents and their staffs confront far more information than they can consume directly. News summaries, clipbooks, and related reports help transform a vast and fragmented media environment into a manageable stream of information. In doing so, they shape what decision-makers learn about the world, what problems receive attention, and which developments are elevated inside the executive branch. This paper provides the historical context necessary for studying those processes and for understanding how media information reaches the White House.

References

- Barabak, M. Z., & Helfand, D. (2010). Anthem politics. *Los Angeles Times*. <https://www.latimes.com/archives/la-xpm-2010-mar-07-la-na-anthem-politics7-2010mar07-story.html>
- Basu, Z., & Caputo, M. (2025). Trump orders agency to cancel all media contracts after politico uproar. In *Axios*. Axios Media Inc. <https://www.axios.com/2025/02/06/trump-politico-subscriptions-doge-elon-musk>
- Benke, G. (2018). *Risk and ruin: Enron and the culture of american capitalism*. University of Pennsylvania Press. <https://dokumen.pub/risk-and-ruin-enron-and-the-culture-of-american-capitalism-9780812295078.html>
- Budoff Brown, C., & Thrush, G. (2010). Pelosi steeled w.h. For health push. *Politico*. <https://www.politico.com/story/2010/03/pelosi-steeled-wh-for-health-push-034753>
- Bulletin Intelligence. (2014). *Ben fritz joins bulletin intelligence as vice president of corporate development*. Business Wire press release.
- Bulletin Intelligence. (2025). *About us*. <https://www.bulletinintelligence.com/about-us/>.
- Bump, P. (2017, November 29). *Here are all the times we're pretty sure that trump was watching fox news as president*. The Washington Post. <https://www.washingtonpost.com/news/politics/wp/2017/11/29/here-are-all-the-times-were-pretty-sure-that-trump-was-watching-fox-news-as-president/>
- Burke, J. P., & Greenstein, F. L. (1989). *How presidents test reality: Decisions on vietnam, 1954 and 1965*. Russell Sage Foundation.
- Carter, J. (1978). *Interview with the president remarks and a question-and-answer session with representatives of the hispanic media*. The American Presidency

- Project; Interview transcript; University of California, Santa Barbara. <https://www.presidency.ucsb.edu/documents/interview-with-the-president-remarks-and-question-and-answer-session-with-0>
- Chadwick, A. (2017). *The hybrid media system: Politics and power*. Oxford University Press.
- Chen, E. (2002). Bush aims to privatize many federal jobs. *Los Angeles Times*. <https://www.latimes.com/archives/la-xpm-2002-nov-15-na-compete15-story.html>
- Chitester, K. (1997). *Aboard air force one*. Fithian Press.
- Chozick, A. (2012). Obama is an avid reader, and critic, of news media coverage. *The New York Times*. <https://www.nytimes.com/2012/08/08/us/politics/obama-is-an-avid-reader-and-critic-of-news-media-coverage.html>
- Cision Ltd. (2017). *Cision acquires bulletin intelligence to expand decision-making support for senior leaders*. PR Newswire press release. <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/cision-acquires-bulletin-intelligence-to-expand-decision-making-support-for-senior-leaders-300429995.html>
- Connolly, C. (2010). *Ceci connolly interview*. Frontline; WGBH Educational Foundation; PBS. <https://www.pbs.org/wgbh/pages/frontline/obamasdeal/interviews/connolly.html>
- Cook, T. E. (1998). *Governing with the news: The news media as a political institution*. University of Chicago Press.
- Cooper, M. (2018). Remembering president bush, my first boss. *Chief Executive*. <https://chiefexecutive.net/president-bush-was-my-first-boss/>
- Dow Jones Newswires. (1997). Desktop data, individual inc. Agree to stock-swap merger. *Dow Jones Newswires*. <https://www.wsj.com/articles/SB878591898601038500>
- Fetig, J. (1999). *Oral history interview with james fetig*. Office of Presidential Libraries, National Archives; Records Administration. <https://www.archives.gov/files/presidential-libraries/research/transition-interviews/pdf/fetig.pdf>
- Ford, G. (1976). *Remarks and a question-and-answer session in portland with members of the national association of broadcasters*. Transcript. <https://www.presidency.ucsb.edu/documents/remarks-and-question-and-answer-session-portland-with-members-the-national-association>
- Ford, G. (1977). *The president's news conference*. News conference transcript. <https://www.presidency.ucsb.edu/documents/the-presidents-news-conference-77>
- Fuller, J. (2014). BREAKING: President obama hates cable news. *The Washington Post*. <https://www.washingtonpost.com/news/the-fix/wp/2014/09/26/breaking-president-obama-hates-cable-news/>
- Gammill, M. B. (1993). Law grad makes living reading news. In *The Harvard Crimson*. The Harvard Crimson. <https://www.thecrimson.com/article/1993/8/13/law-grad-makes-living-reading-news/>
- Gates, R. M. (n.d.). *Robert m. Gates oral history*. Miller Center, University of Virginia. Retrieved June 10, 2026, from <https://millercenter.org/the-presidency/presidential-oral-histories/robert-m-gates-deputy-director-central>
- Grossman, M., & Kumar, M. J. (1981). *Portraying the president: The white house and the news media*. Johns Hopkins University Press.
- Guardian Staff. (2025). State department orders cancellation of media subscriptions around

- world. In *the Guardian*. Guardian News & Media Limited. <https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2025/feb/19/state-department-media-subscriptions-cancelled>
- Halchin, L. E. (2012). *Sourcing policy: Selected developments and issues* (R42341). Congressional Research Service. https://www.congress.gov/crs_external_products/R/PDF/R42341/R42341.4.pdf
- Helfand, D. (2010). Anthem blue cross dramatically raising rates for californians with individual health policies. *Los Angeles Times*. <https://www.latimes.com/archives/la-xpm-2010-feb-04-la-fi-insure-anthem5-2010feb05-story.html>
- Karpowitz, C. F. (2009). What Can a President Learn from the News Media? The Instructive Case of Richard Nixon. *British Journal of Political Science*, 39(4), 755–780. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0007123409990135>
- Kinsley, M. (2003). President bush won't read this story. *Slate*. <https://slate.com/news-and-politics/2003/10/president-bush-won-t-read-this-story.html>
- Kornblut, A. E. (2009). As right jabs continue, white house debates a counterpunching strategy. *The Washington Post*. <https://www.washingtonpost.com/archive/national/2009/09/16/as-right-jabs-continue-white-house-debates-a-counterpunching-strategy/fc17e21d-76e4-4873-a37e-28073df3e9f9/>
- Kornfield, M., Natanson, H., & Paybarah, A. (2025). Despite anti-media rhetoric, the government is still reading the news. In *Washington Post*. Washington Post. <https://www.washingtonpost.com/politics/2025/12/24/paywalled-news-sites-trump-administration/>
- Kumar, M. J., & Jenkins, R. (1999). *White house interview program: Interview with ray jenkins*. Oral history interview.
- Kumar, M. J., & Sullivan, T. O. (2003). *The white house world: Transitions, organization, and office operations*. Texas A&M University Press.
- Lippman, D. (2019, July 29). *The print reader in chief: Inside trump's obsession with newspapers*. Politico. <https://www.politico.com/story/2019/07/29/trump-print-newspapers-media-1437913>
- Lippman, D. (2020). What joe biden reads and watches. *Politico Nightly*. <https://www.politico.com/newsletters/politico-nightly/2020/12/07/what-joe-biden-reads-and-watches-491081>
- McCubbins, M. D., & Schwartz, T. (1984). Congressional oversight overlooked: Police patrols versus fire alarms. *American Journal of Political Science*, 165–179.
- McCurry, M. (1997). *Press briefing by mike McCurry*. The American Presidency Project; White House press briefing transcript; University of California, Santa Barbara. <https://www.presidency.ucsb.edu/documents/press-briefing-mike-mccurry-105>
- McGraw, M. (2024). How donald trump gets his news. *Politico Magazine*. <https://www.politico.com/news/magazine/2024/04/24/donald-trump-news-consumption-00153477>
- Nixon Foundation. (2010, April 7). *Part III – the president's daily news summary*. <https://www.nixonfoundation.org/2010/04/part-iii-the-presidents-daily-news-summary/>
- O'Mara, M. (2015). *Pivotal tuesdays: Four elections that shaped the twentieth century*. University of Pennsylvania Press.
- Popp, R. K. (2014). Information, industrialization, and the business of press clippings, 1880–1925. *The Journal of American History*, 101(2), 427–453.
- Powell, J. (1981). *Jody powell oral history*. Miller Center, University of Virginia. <https://millercenter.org/the-presidency/presidential-oral-histories/jody-powell-oral-history>

- Pugh, C. (1993). White house “elf” digests news. *USA Today*.
- Rigdon, J. I. (1996). Infoseek plans news services, targeting corporate customers. *The Wall Street Journal*. <https://www.wsj.com/articles/SB851390038867961500>
- Smith, D. (2017, January 27). *President trump’s daily routine: Twitter, cable TV and plotting to change america*. The Guardian. <https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2017/jan/27/donald-trump-white-house-twitter-cable-news-sleep>
- Stiles, L. (2017). *The man behind roosevelt: The story of louis McHenry howe*. Papamoa Press.
- Terzano, G. (1994). *Press briefing by ginny terzano*. The American Presidency Project; White House press briefing transcript; University of California, Santa Barbara. <https://www.presidency.ucsb.edu/documents/press-briefing-ginny-terzano-1>
- The Christian Science Monitor. (2000). What the president reads. *The Christian Science Monitor*. <https://www.csmonitor.com/2000/0424/p2s2.html>
- UPI. (1977). White house checking for errors in news reports. *The New York Times*, 71. <https://www.nytimes.com/1977/02/02/archives/long-island-opinion-white-house-checking-for-errors-in-news.html>
- VandeHei, J., & Allen, M. (2017, December 15). *Trump 101: What he reads and watches*. Axios. <https://www.axios.com/2017/12/15/trump-101-what-he-reads-and-watches-1513300066>
- Zwerdling, D. (2008, December 2). *New president faces powerful federal contractors*. NPR. <https://www.npr.org/2008/12/02/97535322/new-president-faces-powerful-federal-contractors>